

Backup & Business Continuity Checklist

Confirm whether your business can recover from ransomware, deletion, outage or device loss.

PURPOSE

Backups are not the same as recoverability

This checklist helps determine whether a business can actually recover from ransomware, accidental deletion, system failure, cloud account compromise or a site-level outage.

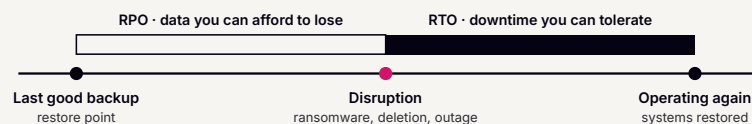
HOW TO USE IT

Nine checks, one honest answer each

- 1 Work through the checks with whoever runs your backups and your key systems.
- 2 Mark **Yes**, **No** or **Unknown** for each. Treat Unknown as an area to review, not a pass.
- 3 Write the owner, and any evidence such as the date of the last restore test, on the notes line.
- 4 Use the result with the next step on the last page.

TERMS

The two targets that matter



RPO and RTO on one timeline.

RTO

Recovery Time Objective: how long the business can tolerate downtime.

RPO

Recovery Point Objective: how much data the business can afford to lose.

BCDR

Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery: the strategy for keeping the business operating during disruption.

01 Backup & BCDR review

What is protected

4 CHECKS

C01	CRITICAL DATA	Do you know which systems and files must be recovered first?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C02	ENDPOINT BACKUP	Are user devices backed up where business data exists locally?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C03	CLOUD DATA	Are Microsoft 365, Google Workspace or other cloud data sources backed up separately?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C04	SERVERS AND SYSTEMS	Are business-critical systems backed up with documented retention?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			

Whether it can be recovered

2 CHECKS

C05	RECOVERY TESTING	Has a restore been tested in the last 90 days?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C06	RANSOMWARE READINESS	Are backups protected from deletion or encryption by compromised accounts?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			

How fast, and how much

2 CHECKS

C07	RECOVERY TIME (RTO)	Do you know how long the business can be down before real damage occurs?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C08	RECOVERY POINT (RPO)	Do you know how much data loss is acceptable?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			

Who owns recovery

1 CHECK

C09DOCUMENTATION

Is the recovery process documented and assigned to responsible parties?

☐ Yes☐ No☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

02 Notes and follow-ups

OWNERS, EVIDENCE, DATES

NEXT STEP

Request a Backup & BCDR review

If restore testing, cloud backup or recovery ownership is unclear, request a Backup & Business Continuity review before assuming the business is protected.

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Educational checklist. It does not assess or certify any environment. This document names no customers and makes no vendor-specific claims.